

COMMENTARY BUILDER

Source Text: *The War Prayer* by Mark Twain

Your task is to evaluate how **resources of language are utilized to achieve purpose and reveal attitude.** Evaluate the writer's rhetorical choices such as *syntax (parallel structure, fragments for emphasis) connotative diction, details, figurative language, etc.* and the effect they have on achieving purpose. Build commentary using vivid verbs from the attached sheet.

Resource of Language (Integrated Quote)	Verb	Effect (Commentary)
The author's observation that "It was indeed a glad and gracious time...when referring to the anticipation of war	highlights	the absurdity of blind allegiance and reveals our inability to consider outcomes other than victory.
Twain's statement that "the drums were beating, the bands playing, the toy pistols popping"	limits	conjunctions in order to emulate the speed at which events are moving, and to illustrate how the people are being swept up in emotion.
"During some moments he surveyed the spellbound audience with solemn eyes..."	establishes	clear and emotional imagery that has been reinforced through an alliterative series of the letter <i>s</i> or the <i>z</i> sound.
The invocation of God to "...help us" followed by acts of violence such as "tear their soldiers to bloody shreds,"	amplifies	a comical yet paradoxical expression of spiritual understanding. While the "War Prayer" itself seems theologically unsound, it is justified by the scripture read from the Old Testament.